

1. The Genesis: Yokosuka, Yamamoto's War Room, and the \$35M Precedent

The modern enterprise network video surveillance market did not begin in a computer science lab or a venture capital boardroom. It was forged in the urgent aftermath of September 11, 2001.

Following 9/11, the United States Navy required an immediate, mission-critical fleet protection system to secure naval assets against asymmetric perimeter threats. The prevailing technology of the era was analog CCTV—tied to local copper coax, physically vulnerable, and incapable of wide-area perimeter coverage.

When Cisco approached our team seeking a deployable solution, the component pieces did not exist in a single commercial catalog:

- **The Hardware Scavenge:** Flying directly to Atlanta, we retrieved the final working wireless video encoder from the shuttered office of a defunct startup.
- **The Mesh Architecture:** In transit, we architected an unprecedented multi-vendor system fusing wireless transmission (**SmartSight**), early edge video analytics (**Litton TASC**), digital video management (**Verint**), and tactical networking (**Cisco**).
- **The Pitch:** We flew directly to Fleet Activities Yokosuka, Japan, presenting the integrated solution to Admiral Chaplin in the historic war room where Admiral Yamamoto directed the Imperial Japanese Navy during World War II.

Admiral Chaplin halted all competing initiatives on the spot and awarded a **\$35 million contract** to deploy the architecture.

When our CEO subsequently asked, *"What the hell did you sell? I didn't think anyone could actually sell that stuff,"* the answer was simple: **We solved an impossible tactical problem under extreme operational constraints.**

2. Catalyst for an Industry: The Roots of SmartSight and Genetec

That Yokosuka deployment fundamentally reshaped the physical security industry:

- To fulfill the Navy's multi-million-dollar operational mandate, **Verint** was forced to acquire **SmartSight**, bringing foundational wireless IP video into enterprise reality.
- Working alongside SmartSight founder **Jean-Paul Saindon**, this inflection point catalyzed **Pierre Racz** and the early team to engineer and expand **Genetec** into the enterprise VMS juggernaut it is today.
- Over the next two decades, as Vice President and commercial executive across the tier-one physical security giants (including Verint, Genetec, and Avigilon), our founder

directed global market expansion, shaped enterprise product roadmaps, and scaled partner networks across multi-billion-dollar product categories.

3. The 20-Year Reckoning: The Calcification of the Dinosaur Stack

Over the past twenty years, the foundational architecture we helped create has calcified into a bloated, rent-seeking oligopoly:

1. **The Server & Storage Tax:** Legacy VMS platforms turned enterprise security directors into server farm operators—forcing customers to buy, cool, and maintain \$10k+ rackmount Windows NVRs just to store petabytes of static, empty gravel.
2. **The Software Maintenance Agreement (SMA) Trap:** Customers are locked into punitive annual maintenance fees and per-camera connection tolls simply to keep software running.
3. **The "Stanford AI" Bandwidth Mirage:** The latest cohort of venture-backed startups attempt to layer cloud analytics on top of these dinosaurs. By demanding 25 Mbps uplinks to stream raw video into centralized GPU clusters, they choke enterprise networks, generate catastrophic cellular overage bills, and demand a second, third, or fourth SaaS subscription.
4. **Failure in Contested Environments:** In DDIL (Denied, Disrupted, Intermittent, Limited) environments, this entire cloud-streaming architecture collapses into complete darkness.

4. The Thesis: Replacement, Not Integration

The next generational security titan will not be built by 24-year-olds selling API wrappers that plug into 2005-era VMS software.

VectorEdge does not integrate with the dinosaurs—it retires them.

- **Single Platform Replacement:** Consolidate the bloated legacy stack (VMS + Storage + Analytics + Egress) into a single, edge-native subscription.
- **Microsecond Edge Kinematics:** Replacing raw video streaming with 1D additive log-odds classification and Poisson arrival modeling executed directly on 15–50 ARM silicon.
- **64-Byte Tactical Telemetry:** Slashing network transmission by 99.9%—delivering resilient physical awareness across degraded radio links, satellite uplinks, or severed infrastructure.

"We didn't read about this market in an industry analyst report. We scavenged the prototype, won the naval fleet protection contracts, and helped forge the companies that defined the last twenty years of enterprise security. We know where their

margins bleed, we know why their codebases cannot adapt, and we are building the unified architecture that replaces them."